Il Chubby Babi

A LaTeX cookbook by Bruno Belotti

Last edited on November 1, 2026

I associate the beginning of my personal culinary journey with my very first year of undergraduate studies in Lausanne, Switzerland. My kitchen-uneducated young self somehow managed to burn plain boiled rice, twice, and give myself food poisoning from undercooked, clearly spoiled butternut squash. Thankfully, before long, I was exposed to the cooking of Elio Zanini, whom I consider my mentor in culinary literacy. The original Chubby Babi was born at Chemin de Pierreval 8, Lausanne, as an empty notebook gifted to me by Simona Scopazzini. The first culinary masterpiece recorded in the book was Carlo Emilio Gadda's 'Risotto Patrio', followed over the years by many more recipes carrying my official seal of approval. While I still avoid butternut squash like the plague, cooking has, over time, developed into a half passion. It is now 2026, and one could easily infer the contents of the physical Chubby Babi by looking solely at the collection of stains that have accumulated on its pages. Thus, in an effort to preserve its legacy, and after multiple requests for a shareable format from folks who share excellent culinary taste, I have decided to digitize the Chubby Babi, now compiled into this practical LaTeX document. While I plan to add recipes to this cookbook indefinitely, I hope that you will enjoy its current repertoire.

Current and future goals: Finish transferring recipes from the physical book; at the request of Bailee Zinzer, I aim to specify gluten-free alternatives for suitable recipes.

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Mains & Components

Calzonso's Birria

For 6–8 servings. Refer to the recipe video by "La Capital" on YouTube.

Ingredients

- 2 kg beef[1]
- 2–3 marrow bones
- 7 guajillo chiles[2]
- 5 ancho chiles[2]
- Árbol chile pods, as needed[3]
- 1 medium onion, quartered
- 6 garlic cloves
- 1 small (2 cm) piece of ginger
- 1 teaspoon ground cumin
- 1 teaspoon dried oregano
- ½ teaspoon ground cloves
- ½ teaspoon black pepper
- 3 bay leaves
- 1 small cinnamon stick
- Love (non optional)
- Morita chiles
- Oaxaca cheese[4]
- Salt
- Olive oil
- Corn tortillas
- Fresh cilantro and onion

Add the **guajillo**, **ancho**, and **árbol chiles** to a pot and cover them with water. Bring the water to a boil, then turn off the heat and let the chiles rest for approximately 20 minutes. Drain and set aside. In a dry skillet over low heat, gently toast the **garlic**, **ginger**, **cumin**, **oregano**, **cloves**, **black pepper**, and **cinnamon**. Toast each ingredient separately, as they require different cooking times. Be careful not to burn them. Blend the softened **chiles**, **onion**, **garlic**, **ginger**, **cumin**, **oregano**, **cloves**, **black pepper**, and **cinnamon** until smooth. Place the **beef** in a large pot and cover it with the **adobo** (the blended mix). Marinate the meat for at least 2 hours.

Add enough **water** to cover the meat, along with the **marrow bones** and **bay leaves**. Cook on low heat for 3–4 hours, or until the meat is tender. Only add the **salt** after the third hour. Wash and dry the **morita chiles**. Heat **olive oil** in a small frying pan. Fry the chiles until they puff up, but do not let them burn. Allow them to cool, then add them to the broth along with the frying oil. Once the birria is cooked, skim off the fat from the surface of the broth. Reserve the fat for cooking the quesadillas.

To prepare the quesadillas, dip a **corn tortilla** into the reserved birria fat and place it in a hot skillet. Add the **beef** and **cheese**, fold the tortilla, and cook until the cheese melts and the tortilla becomes slightly crisp. Serve the birria with the quesadillas, chopped **cilantro**, and **onion**. Serve the broth separately in a cup.

[1] Prefer meat with both fat and lean parts like chuck roast, short rib, oxtail, beef shanks.
[2] Stemmed, seeded, and dried
[3] This is what delivers the spiciness.
[4] If Oaxaca is not available, use mozzarella.

Burger Buns

Makes anywhere between 4 very large buns and 8 small ones.

Ingredients

Bread

- 450 g AP flour
- 235 ml water
- 1 egg
- 3 tbsp melted butter
- 3 tbsp granulated sugar
- 7 g dry yeast
- Salt
- Sesame seeds

Egg wash

- 1 egg
- 1 tbsp milk

Put the **yeast** in the **water** and let it wake up,[1] then add the **egg**, **butter**, **sugar**, and **salt**. Mix well while adding the **flour**. Let rise for 2h in a warm place.[2] Form the desired number of balls (4 to 8), set on an oven tray, cover, and let rise for another hour. Preheat the oven to 190°C, brush the buns with the well-mixed **egg** and **milk**, then bake for 15-20 minutes.

[1] Add a pinch of flour and sugar to help. Wait a few minutes, until the surface foams.
[2] I usually leave it in the oven with the light on.

Café de Paris

A rich Swiss steak herbs sauce

Ingredients

- 125 g butter
- 1 egg yolk
- 1 generous tsp Dijon mustard
- ½ tbsp Cognac (or Brandy)
- ½ tsp white wine
- ½ tsp rosemary
- ½ tsp parsley
- 1 small anchovy
- ½ tsp thyme
- ½ tsp ground shallot
- ½ tsp ground garlic
- ½ tsp mild curry powder
- Pinch of salt
- Pinch of pepper
- Pinch of paprika

Place the softened **butter** and **all the other ingredients** in a bowl. Mash thoroughly and mix with a fork until a paste forms. Using plastic wrap, shape into a log and let it firm up in the refrigerator. Melt a tbsp or two on your steak.

Carbonara Pasta

Ingredients per person

- 80-120 g (2.8-4.2 oz) of pasta, according to the anticipated appetite of those at the table[1]
- 2 egg yolks, plus 1 whole egg per 2 people[2]
- 40 g (1.4 oz) *guanciale*, cut into short strips[3]
- 15 g (0.5 oz) grated Pecorino Romano[4]
- Salt and pepper

Cook the **pasta** just beyond al dente in salted water.[5] Fry the **guanciale** in a large skillet, which will later need to accommodate all the pasta. Remove the guanciale from the skillet when golden but still soft, leaving all the rendered fat in the skillet, and turn off the heat. Meanwhile, in a bowl, thoroughly mix the **egg yolks/eggs**, grated **Pecorino**, a little **salt**,[6] and as much **pepper** as desired with a fork. Once the pasta is cooked, reserve a ladleful (or a small glass) of the cooking water before draining, then transfer the pasta to the skillet with the guanciale fat. Pour a little of the cooking water into the skillet with the pasta and, stirring continuously, add the egg and Pecorino mixture. This is the stage that separates a good Carbonara from scrambled eggs: the egg should thicken into an emulsion together with the fat and water, ideally becoming pasteurized by the residual heat of the skillet, but it must absolutely not cook to the point of curdling.[7] Once the desired consistency has been achieved, add the guanciale and serve with additional pepper and grated Pecorino.

[1] Spaghetti are the traditional choice, but I personally prefer rigatoni. An excellent brand of pasta which is often found outside of Italy is *Rummo*.

[2] Different schools of thought disagree on the use of egg yolks, whole eggs, or a combination of the two. An excellent Carbonara can also be made using 1 whole egg per person, plus one egg "*for the pot*". If favoring the yolk-based version, the remaining egg whites can be used to prepare "Meringues" (p. 37).

[3] *Guanciale* is an Italian cured pork product made from a pig's cheek. If *guanciale* is not available to you, you can substitute it with *pancetta*, but know that this will change the "soul" of your carbonara. *Pancetta* is made from pork belly and, among other processing differences, is not smoked like bacon, which is your last option to substitute *guanciale*. In the US, *pancetta* is typically available in many grocery stores.

[4] Pecorino Romano (literally, "Roman sheep cheese") is a hard, aged Italian cheese made from sheep milk. In the US, pecorino is often sold at Costco, but can substituted with Parmesan cheese. Just like with *guanciale*, this substitution will inevitably change the fundamental nature of your final dish, offering a less salty and pungent result.

[5] As a rule, the salt level of the cooking water should correspond to the desired saltiness of the pasta cooked in it.

[6] The Pecorino and guanciale will provide plenty of natural saltiness on their own.

[7] The ultimate goal of a creamy sauce is achieved by skillfully combining continuous stirring, the addition of more cooking water, and—only if the skillet has cooled to the point where the sauce no longer thickens—turning the heat back on to the very lowest setting.

Crêpes

Find the Crêpes recipe on page 31. Leave out the sugar for a savory version.

Garlic Shrimp Stir Fry

For 2-3 servings.

Ingredients

- Rice or other side of choice
- 6 garlic cloves, minced
- 60 ml (¼ cup) soy sauce
- 60 ml (¼ cup) water
- 2 tbsp light brown sugar
- 1 tbsp sesame oil
- 1 tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 tbsp chili sauce (like *sambal oelek*)
- 1 tbsp corn starch
- 1 red bell pepper, sliced
- Any other veggies of choice
- Shrimp or any other protein of choice[1]

Start by cooking the **rice** (or side of choice). In a small bowl, combine the minced **garlic** with the **water**, **soy sauce**, **sugar**, **sesame oil**, **chili sauce**, and **corn starch**. Whisk until smooth.

In a large skillet, add the **vegetable oil** over medium-high heat, add the **bell pepper** and the other **veggies**, depending on their cooking time. Sauté until softened (∼5 minutes), then add the **shrimp** and cook until pink and opaque.

Pour the **sauce** into the skillet and cook until it thickens enough to coat the shrimp. Serve over the rice.

[1] If making this dish with beef, chicken, or pork, consider *velveting* the meat first: this simple and fast tenderizing step will give the meat that restaurant-like texture: for every 250 g (8 oz) of striped meat, add ¾ tsp of baking soda, mix well, refrigerate for ∼20 minutes, rinse, and shake off the excess water before stir frying.

Mac & Cheese

Daniel's favorite. Serves 4 (o 1.5 Daniels)

Ingredients

- 460 g elbow macaroni
- 60 g butter
- 36 g AP flour
- 480 ml milk
- Grated cheese:
  - 70 g blue cheese
  - 70g parmesan
  - 80 g sharp cheddar
  - 60 g gouda
- 4 cloves of garlic, ½ crushed, and ½ finely chopped
- Salt and pepper
- 1 Habanero, or other pepper of choice, finely diced (optional)
- Olive oil (optional)

Start cooking the **macaroni** to *al dente*. In parallel, if you like a pleasurably spicy-hot mac, pan fry the **Habanero** in a separate pan with a tablespoon of olive oil, until slightly golden.

In the meantime, melt the **butter** in a large stainless steel pan, add the **flour** and vigorously whisk until smooth.[1] After the buttery flour mix has been bubbling for a couple of minutes, add the crushed garlic[2] and mix for another minute. While whisking, slowly add the **milk** to the mixture. Progressively add all the **grated cheese** and, finally add the diced **garlic**, just before taking the sauce off the heat.

Season to taste with **salt and pepper**, then serve on the warm macaroni.

[1] The result is what the French call "*roux*"

[2] For a stronger garlic taste, add less garlic at this stage, leaving more to be added raw later.

Ryan's Mashed Potatoes

Unsure which part of the process allowed my ex-roommate, Ryan Maxwell, to achieve such a consistently delicious result, I report below the preparation exactly as performed by him, lest the secret reside in his skillful execution. For best results, make this recipe using an instant pot or pressure cooker. Original recipe from thesaltymarshmallow.com

Ingredients

- 6 lb Idaho potatoes
- 4 tsp salt
- ½ cup butter
- ½ cup sour cream
- ½ cup milk
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- 1 tsp pepper

Peel and chop the **potatoes** into quarters. Put the potatoes in the instant pot or pressure cooker, add the **salt** and add water until the potatoes are covered. Make sure that the "maximum capacity" line of your instant pot is abundantly surpassed. Pressure-cook the potatoes for 8 minutes.[1,2] Once the potatoes are cooked, use the manual pressure release valve to spray the contents of the overfilled instant pot onto every exposed surface of your kitchen.[3,4] Shower. Drain the potatoes and return them to the instant pot. Eat something out of the trash can. Add the **butter**, **milk**, **sour cream**, **garlic powder**, and **pepper**. Mash until you obtain a smooth, velvety texture. Enjoy these delicious mashed potatoes with your friends.

[1] The instant pot is now basically a bomb.

[2] If you do not have an instant pot or pressure cooker, simply boil the potatoes in a pot until tender.

[3] This includes the ceiling.

[4] Use a single towel to protect your arm and hand from getting 3rd degree burns.

Moussaka

Ingredients

For the Meat Sauce

- 1 kg (2.2 lb) lean ground meat (½ beef and ½ pork)
- 100 g (3.5 oz) unseasoned tomato sauce (*passata*)
- 25 g (1.5 tbsp) tomato paste
- 1 onion
- 1 celery stalk
- 2 garlic cloves
- ½ tsp sugar
- 1 glass (175 ml / ¾ cup) red wine
- 2 bay leaves
- 1 cinnamon stick
- Star anise, to taste
- Parsley, to taste
- Nutmeg, to taste
- Olive oil, as needed
- Salt and black pepper, to taste

For the Layers

- 1 kg (2.2 lb) eggplants
- If frying:
  - Flour, as needed
  - Frying oil
- 3 potatoes (optional)

For the Yogurt Béchamel

- 500 g (2 cups) milk
- 250 g (1 cup) Greek yogurt
- 50 g (⅓ cup) flour
- 50 g (3.5 tbsp) butter
- Nutmeg, to taste
- Black pepper, to taste

To Assemble

- Parmesan cheese, to taste
- Breadcrumbs, to taste
- Dried oregano, to taste
- Olive oil, as needed

Start with the meat sauce:
Roughly chop the **celery** and **onion**. Sauté them with the **garlic** until softened, then add the **sugar**. Add the **ground meat** and brown it over high heat, breaking it up with a wooden spoon. After about 5 minutes, deglaze with the **red wine** and season with the **bay leaves**, **star anise**, and **cinnamon**. Stir in the **tomato passata** and **tomato paste**, mix well, and let simmer over medium-high heat, then add the chopped **parsley**. Season with **nutmeg**, **salt**, and **black pepper**. Reduce the heat and cook uncovered for approximately 1.5 hours.

Prepare the eggplants and potatoes:
Slice the **eggplants** lengthwise into slices about 1 cm (¾ in) thick, and the **potatoes** into slices about ½ cm (¼ in) thick. Traditionally, the vegetables are dredged in flour and fried, but alternatively they may be brushed with olive oil

and baked for a simpler, lighter version.[1] Set them aside.

Prepare the yogurt béchamel:
Heat the **milk** separately. In a saucepan, melt the **butter** over medium-low heat and stir in the **flour** to make a golden roux.[2] Gradually add the hot milk while whisking constantly to eliminate any lumps, then season with **salt**, **black pepper**, and **nutmeg**. Once you have a thick béchamel, remove it from the heat and let it cool for 5 minutes before stirring in the **Greek yogurt**, then adjust the seasoning with salt, pepper, and nutmeg.

Assemble the moussaka:
Grease a deep baking dish (base approximately 26×20 cm (10×8 in)) with **olive oil**, spread a thin layer of béchamel over the bottom, arrange all the potatoes in a single layer, add a layer of eggplants, and sprinkle with **Parmesan cheese**, **breadcrumbs**, and **dried oregano**. Cover with all of the meat sauce. Arrange another layer of eggplants, then sprinkle again with Parmesan cheese, breadcrumbs, and dried oregano. Cover everything with the remaining béchamel, then finish with another sprinkling of breadcrumbs and Parmesan cheese. Bake in a preheated oven at 180°C (350°F) for approximately 45 minutes.

[1] In this case, sprinkle the slices with salt on both sides and let them release some of their moisture for about ½ hour, then pat them thoroughly dry before assembling the moussaka.

[2] A *roux* is the classic French mixture of equal parts butter and flour cooked together and used as the base for many sauces.

Ciabatta bread

Brian Lagerstrom's recipe, Makes 2 large ciabattas.

Ingredients

For the Biga

- 175 g warm water
- ¼ tsp active dry yeast
- 225 g bread flour (11.7% protein)

For the Autolyse

- 180 g warm water
- 250 g bread flour

For the Final Mix

- 40 g warm water
- 5 g active dry yeast
- 10 g salt
- All of the biga

Prepare the biga, ideally the day before:
Combine the **water**, **yeast**, and **flour** in a tall container, mix well, and cover. Leave to ferment at room temperature for 6–24 hours.

Autolyse:
Combine the **water** and **flour** in the bowl of a stand mixer. Mix with the dough hook on low speed until fully combined, then cover with a clean kitchen towel and let rest for 30 minutes.

Final mix:
Add the **remaining ingredients** and the **biga** to the autolysed dough. Mix on low speed for 3 minutes until well combined, then on high speed for 5 minutes. The dough should clean the sides of the bowl and become smooth, glossy, and elastic.

Bulk fermentation:
Transfer the dough to a large, well-oiled container, cover, and let rise for 30 minutes.

Perform a strength-building fold[1] and let rise for another 30 minutes.

Perform another strength-building fold or, even better, *laminate* the dough,[2] then let rest for 1 hour.

[1] strength-building fold: see the recipe Neapolitan Pizza (p. 17), footnote 3.

[2] Lamination is a technique used to strengthen dough. In pastry, it typically involves folding layers of butter into the dough to create many distinct layers, as in croissants. For bread dough, it consists of stretching the dough into a thin sheet on a wet work surface, folding the sides inward like a letter, and then rolling it back onto itself to form a tight dough ball. Brian Lagerstrom demonstrates this technique in the recipe video linked at the top of this page, below the title.

Shape the ciabattas:
Flour the dough and the work surface, then gently turn the dough out, taking care to release it cleanly from the container without deflating it. Divide the dough in half and, **very gently**, without pressing or further working it, shape each piece into a rectangular ciabatta loaf. Transfer them to floured parchment paper, cover, and let rest for 30 minutes.

Baking:
Preheat the oven to 260°C. Place the ciabattas in the oven together with a container of boiling water,[3] and bake for approximately 25 minutes, until deeply golden brown.

[3]The container of boiling water replaces the humidity control found in professional bread ovens. During the first stage of baking, the steam keeps the surface of the dough moist, delaying crust formation and allowing the loaves to expand more fully. Once the crust begins to form, the steam contributes to a thinner, crispier crust and promotes deeper browning.

Pasta with Anchovies

Original recipe: ricette.giallozafferano.it. Serves 4

Ingredients

- 400 g pasta (ideally spaghetti)
- 30 g anchovies in oil, drained
- 35 g tomato paste
- 30 g pine nuts
- 1 clove of garlic
- 1 small bunch of parsley
- ½ fresh chili pepper
- White wine for deglazing
- Extra virgin olive oil, as needed
- 1 tablespoon of mascarpone per person (optional)

Boil the **pasta**, setting aside a small glass of the cooking water. Divide the **anchovies** into thirds, pouring their oil directly into a pan to heat. Melt ⅓ of the anchovies in the pan over medium heat. Meanwhile, on a cutting board, finely chop the rest of the anchovies together with the **pine nuts**, the **parsley**, the **garlic**, and the **chili pepper**.

Once the anchovies in the pan have melted, add a little cooking water and the **tomato paste**. Let it reduce, then add the aromatic mixture and sauté it for a couple of minutes.[1] Deglaze with the **white wine**. Add the al dente pasta, drained, to the pan, along with a bit more of the cooking water if needed. If desired, add a tablespoon of fresh mascarpone per person.

Acciughe
Acciughe salate.
Acciughe sebbele
Trote salmonate.

Salmone
Capparossoli,
Risotto
Al nero di seppia.

Spaghetti
All'aragosta.

Anguilla
Frittura mista,

Polpa di granchio
Scampi alla griglia.

Salmone
Capparossoli,
Risotto
Al nero di seppia.

Spaghetti
All'aragosta.

Spaghetti allo scoglio
Pizza mari e monti.
Paste di gamberi,

Ma soprattutto
Acciughe
Acciughe salate.

Peoci e trote,
Salmone e seppie,
Anguille, granchio,
Scampi, salmone.

Acciughe
Acciughe salate.

—*Superlova*

[1] If necessary, add a little more olive oil.

Piadine (Italian flatbread)

Makes 3 piadine

Ingredients

- 1 dl water
- 180 g flour
- 1 tbsp milk
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- ½ tsp salt

In a bowl, mix together **all the ingredients**, adding the **flour** gradually.

Let the dough rest for 10 minutes (covered or wrapped in plastic in the refrigerator).

Divide the dough into 3 balls and roll them out. Cook in a skillet over medium-high heat for about 1 minute, until bubbles form.

Neapolitan Pizza

From Brian Lagerstrom's recipe. Makes 4 pizzas. Dough needs to rise overnight!

Ingredients

- 450 g water
- 6 pinches active dry yeast (⅛ tsp)
- 665 g '00' flour (or all purpose flour)
- 20 g salt

Add the **yeast** to the **water**,[1] then add the **flour** and **salt**. Mix well with a spoon, then knead with a stand mixer[2] until smooth and elastic. Cover and let rest for 30 minutes.

Perform a strength-building fold to develop the gluten,[3] then cover and let rest for another 30 minutes.

Perform another strength-building fold, then cover and let the dough proof at room temperature for 12 hours.

Divide the dough into 4 balls and place them in lightly oiled containers in the refrigerator for at least 2 hours, or up to 5 days.

Remove from the refrigerator 3 hours before making the pizza. Stretch the pizzas on a well-floured surface, add the desired toppings,[4] then bake in a preheated oven, ideally on a pizza stone, for about 10 minutes (the bottom should begin to develop nicely dark or slightly charred spots).

"In Naples they invented pizza.
And everyone honks their horns,
because they want to have pizza."
—the Rizzello Brothers.

[1] To properly activate the yeast, dissolve it in warm water with a teaspoon of sugar or flour and let it sit for 5–10 minutes, until foamy.

[2] If you do not have a stand mixer, the dough can also be kneaded by hand. However, as with bread, the resulting crust will generally be less open, airy, and professional-looking.

[3] *Strength-building fold*: without removing the dough from its container, grab one side of the dough, stretch it upward, and fold it over to the opposite side. Repeat on all four sides, forming an "X". Turn the dough over so the seam is facing down before letting it rest again. Brian Lagerstrom has several videos, including the one linked under the title of this recipe, demonstrating this technique.

[4] I recommend stretching the pizza (strictly by hand), then transferring it to a well-floured wooden or aluminum pizza peel before adding the toppings. Trying to lift a fully topped pizza directly from the work surface requires considerable skill and, in inexperienced hands, often ends in disaster. Also, try to leave the pizza on the peel for as little time as possible, especially after adding wet ingredients (such as tomato sauce), since the moisture will cause it to stick to the peel.

Chicken in a Basket

The Attinghausen-style recipe. A.k.a. "Devil's Chicken" (—Bailee Z., lactose intolerant.) Serves 2.

Ingredients

For the marinade

- 1 whole chicken (1 kg)
- 2 dl sour cream
- 3 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp black pepper
- 2 tsp salt
- a pinch of dried garlic

For the sauce

- 1 large or 2 small shallots
- 2 tbsp olive oil
- White wine, for deglazing
- 1 dl vegetable stock
- 2.5 dl heavy cream
- 1.5 tsp mustard
- 0.5 tsp Madras curry powder
- 0.5 tsp tarragon
- 60 g butter
- black pepper, to taste
- salt, to taste

To serve

- French fries
- Cornichons

Marinate the **chicken** in the well-mixed marinade for at least 4 hours in the refrigerator, turning it occasionally. Remove it from the refrigerator 30 minutes before roasting. Roast the chicken in the center of the oven[1] at 200°C for about 1 hour. Cook for 20 minutes on each side, then switch to the grill setting for another 10 minutes per side. If serving **French fries**, bake them during the last 20 minutes of the chicken's cooking time, then continue baking them for another 10 minutes while the chicken rests outside the oven.

For the sauce, sauté the **shallot** in the **olive oil** and deglaze with the **white wine**. Once the wine has evaporated, add the **vegetable stock** and cook for 1 minute. Add the **cream**, **curry powder**, **black pepper**, **tarragon**, and **mustard**. Simmer gently for 10–15 minutes until slightly reduced (the butter will loosen it again), then stir in the **butter** and finally adjust the **salt** to taste. If necessary, keep the sauce over very low heat, stirring occasionally, until the chicken is ready. It should have a nice glossy appearance. Serve half a chicken per person in a basket with the sauce, half a cornichon, and the French fries on the side. Eat strictly with your hands.

[1] Alternatively, directly on the oven rack. In this case, place a baking tray filled with water underneath the chicken to catch the dripping fat.

Risotto Patrio

Perfected, in my not-so-humble opinion, from Carlo Emilio Gadda's version. Serves 4.

Ingredients

- 1 onion, finely diced
- 350 g risotto rice[1]
- High-quality Lodi butter, *quantum prodest*
- 1.5 L richly flavored beef stock
- 0.2 g (or 50 threads) saffron
- White wine, for deglazing
- Grated Parmigiano Reggiano
- Porcini, chanterelles, or morel mushrooms

Equipment

- Tinned copper saucepan (or aluminum, but do not use a non-stick pot)
- Ladle
- Wooden spoon

In a separate bowl or pot, prepare 1.5 L of **saffron-infused beef stock** so that it is ready to use. If available, add the **mushrooms** to the stock as well. In the saucepan, melt some **butter**[2] and gently cook the finely diced **onion**. As soon as the buttery onion mixture begins to sizzle, add the **rice** and toast it, stirring against the copper bottom. Deglaze with the **white wine**. Then begin cooking the rice by adding the stock a ladleful at a time until the rice is cooked: not overdone, but just beyond *al dente*. Remove the risotto from the heat, *mantecate*[3] it, and add as much **Parmigiano Reggiano** as you like. Cover with a lid and let it rest for 10 minutes before serving.[4]

[1] The Vialone type is ideal, but the Arborio is easier to find in the US.

[2] Optionally, add a tablespoon of olive oil so that the butter is less likely to burn.

[3] To *mantecare* a risotto means to vigorously stir in cold butter and grated Parmigiano Reggiano off the heat until the risotto becomes smooth, creamy, and glossy.

[4] Best enjoyed with some rustic bread and a glass of red wine.

Alonso's Shrimp Dumplings

Makes ∼50 dumplings.

For the filling

- 500 g shrimp
- 3 green onions
- 3 garlic cloves
- 2 carrots
- 6 leaves Chinese Cabbage[1]
- 2 serrano peppers
- 1 tbsp oyster sauce
- 1 tbsp fish sauce
- 1 tbsp soy sauce
- 1 big chunk of ginger
- 2 tbsp sesame oil
- Salt and pepper
- Love (optional)

For the wrappers[2]

- 415 g flour
- 110 ml water

Start with the filling[3]*:* Chop the **shrimp** into cm-sized cubes. Mince the **other solid ingredients**. Mix in all the **wet ingredients**.

Continue with the wrappers: mix **flour** and **water** together until well-combined, then knead to obtain a smooth dough. Wrap the dough in plastic and let it rest for 45-60 minutes.[4] Divide the dough into 4 equal pieces: each piece will yield approximately twelve ∼11 g wrappers.[5]

Make the dumplings: Put ∼1 tablespoon of filling in the center of each wrapper, moisten the edges of the wrapper with some water to help sealing, then fold and seal the dumpling using whichever sealing technique you prefer.[6]

Heat a frying pan on medium heat with high smoke point vegetable oil, arrange the first batch of dumplings in the pan leaving some space between them, as they will grow during cooking. As soon as the bottoms of the dumplings have browned, add ½ cup of water mixed with 1 tsp of flour into the pan, and cover with the lid. Let the dumplings steam until the water has evaporated and a brown crust has formed, approximately 4 minutes.[7] Repeat until all the dumplings are done.

[1] Regular cabbage works too.

[2] Making homemade wrappers can be risky: the quantities will vary depending on the type of flour used as well as current temperature and humidity. I will exceptionally suggest buying pre-made wrappers unless you are most confident in your wrapper-making skills, because excessively dry or moist wrappers will result in the wrong integrity and elasticity, in turn making it very difficult to obtain good dumplings.

[3] If you are cooking with friends, have someone start working on the wrappers.

[4] This is important, as it will soften the dough and give it elasticity.

[5] Keep the unused dough in plastic so it won't dry.

[6] There are plenty of Youtube videos showing how to properly fold dumplings.

[7] It is wiser to risk overcooking your dumplings than eating raw shrimp.

French Onion Soup

Serves 4

Ingredients

Soup

- 6 yellow onions[1]
- 55 g butter
- 125 ml red wine
- 30 ml Cognac (Brandy will work, too)
- ½ L chicken stock
- ½ L beef stock
- 1 tbsp flour
- 1 pinch ground nutmeg

Topping

- 200 g grated Gruyère
- Toasted baguette slices
- 1 garlic clove

Cut the **onions** into quarters, then thinly slice them into short strips. In a large saucepan over medium heat, soften the onions in the **butter** for 15 minutes. Continue cooking over high heat for another 15 minutes, or until the onions are well caramelized, stirring constantly and scraping the bottom of the pan. Deglaze with the **red wine** and the **Cognac** (or Brandy), then reduce until almost dry. Add the **chicken stock**, **beef stock**, **flour**, and **nutmeg**. Simmer over medium-high heat for 30 minutes, or until the soup has reduced by about half. Season with salt and pepper.

Ladle the soup into bowls, top each with the garlic-rubbed toasted baguette slices, generously cover with the grated Gruyère, and shortly broil in the oven until the cheese is melted, bubbling, and golden.

[1]The European variety, which rarely exceeds 3 inches in ⌀, versus the softball+ size of PNW onions. Plan accordingly.

Stroganoff Pasta

Serves 4.

Ingredients

- 1 kg sirloin or chuck steak
- 50 g (3 tbsp) soy sauce
- 35 g (2 tbsp) Worcestershire sauce (15 g for the marinade and 20 g for the sauce)
- 200 g or about 1 onion, finely diced
- 450 g button mushrooms, sliced
- 4–5 garlic cloves (minced or crushed)
- High-smoke-point vegetable oil
- Salt and black pepper
- 175 g (1 glass) dry white wine
- 25 g (1.5 tbsp) tomato paste
- 15 g (2 tbsp) flour
- 400 g beef stock, with 3 packets unflavoured powdered gelatin dissolved in it (optional)
- 25 g (1⅔ tbsp) Dijon mustard
- 450 g pasta of your choice
- 65 g butter
- 75 g heavy cream

Tenderize (or *Jaccard*) the **steak** by piercing it with a fork. Place it in a bag with the **soy sauce** and 15 g of the **Worcestershire sauce**, then refrigerate for 15–20 minutes while preparing the remaining ingredients.

Pat the steak dry and heat some **oil** in a heavy-bottomed skillet (ideally cast iron). Add the steak, pressing firmly against the pan. Cook over medium-high heat for 1.5 minutes on one side, or until well browned, then 2–3 minutes on the other side. Transfer the meat to a plate and loosely wrap it in foil.

Add another splash of oil to the skillet, then add the **mushrooms** with a pinch of salt. Stir and deglaze[1] the pan with a wooden spoon. Sauté for 4–5 minutes, until some of the mushrooms' moisture has evaporated. Add the **onion** with another pinch of salt, stir, and cook for 3–4 minutes. Add the **garlic** and cook for about 20 seconds, then pour in the **white wine**. Deglaze thoroughly and, once the wine has reduced slightly, stir in the **tomato paste** and **flour**. These will coat the bottom of the pan in about a minute.

Add the **beef stock** with the dissolved **gelatin**, deglaze, and bring to a boil. Stir in the **Dijon mustard**, the remaining **Worcestershire sauce**, and some **black pepper**. Cover and let the sauce simmer gently for about 10 minutes, then stir in the **heavy cream**. Meanwhile, cook the **pasta**. Slice the steak into thin strips and add it to the reduced sauce. Toss everything together, ensuring the meat is heated through, and serve.

[1] In this recipe, as in many others—particularly in French cuisine—deglazing is an essential step that builds a deep and complex flavor.

Sushi rice (鮨飯 / すしめし)

Makes enough for ∼8 rolls

Ingredients

- 360 g (2 cups) raw sushi rice (e.g., pearl)
- 60 g (¼ cup) rice vinegar
- 4 tsp sugar
- 1 tsp salt

Start cooking the **rice** at least 4 hours before you plan to start rolling your sushi.[1] While the rice cooks, mix **all other ingredients** together in a glass or bowl.[2] Once the rice is done, mix in the liquid, stir well, and let the rice cool completely, covered.

[1] Ensure you prepare the sushi with style, like in a real おまかせ.
[2] Microwaving the mix for 10 seconds will help dissolve the salt and sugar.

Sauces & Custards

Burger Sauce

Ingredients

- 125 g mayonnaise
- 60 g ketchup
- 15 g shallot or onion
- 25 g of sriracha or chili
- 15 g Dijon mustard
- 60 g (=1 medium) pickle
- ½ garlic clove
- 2 g salt (a generous pinch)
- 2 g pepper

Blend **all the ingredients** with a (hand-held) food processor and serve. Can be done without a food processor by finely mincing all the solid ingredients with a knife.

Lemon Cream

Double the recipe if using it to fill a tart.

Ingredients

- 1 egg
- 100 g sugar
- 1 tbsp cornstarch
- Juice and zest of 1 unwaxed lemon
- 100 ml cold water

In a saucepan, vigorously whisk together **all the ingredients**. Cook over low heat, stirring occasionally, until the cream has thickened. The longer it cooks, the thicker and firmer the cream will become.

Pastry Cream

Ingredients

- 500 g (17.6 oz) whole milk
- 130 g (4.6 oz) sugar
- 7 egg yolks[1]
- 40 g (1.4 oz) cornstarch
- 2 vanilla pods, or 6 g (0.21 oz) vanilla extract
- Zest of ½ lemon

If using **vanilla pods**, scrape out the seeds and cut the pods into small pieces. Pour the **milk** into a saucepan, add half of the **sugar**, the **vanilla**, and the **lemon zest**.

Bring to a boil over medium-low heat. Meanwhile, in a separate bowl, combine the **egg yolks** (and, if using it, the **egg**) with the other half of the **sugar** and the **cornstarch**. Whisk until smooth and creamy. As soon as the milk reaches a gentle boil, pour a little of it into the bowl with the egg mixture to temper it, then slowly pour the entire mixture back into the milk in a thin stream, whisking continuously.

After a few minutes of careful whisking, the cream will thicken, almost suddenly. Remove it from the heat as soon as it reaches the desired consistency, immediately pour it into a cold container, and let it cool in the refrigerator.[2]

[1] For a lighter version, replace the 7 egg yolks with 2 egg yolks and 1 whole egg.

[2] To prevent a skin from forming on the surface of the cream as it cools, press some plastic wrap against its surface.

Sweets

Banana Bread

Makes one loaf.

Ingredients

- 3 or 4 very ripe bananas
- 110 g (½ cup) unsalted butter at room temperature
- 150 g (¾ cup) granulated sugar
- 2 large eggs
- 188 g (1½ cup) flour
- 1 tsp baking soda
- ½ tsp salt
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 200 g (1-2 cups) filling of choice[1]

Preheat the oven to 177°C (350°F), grease and flour a bread loaf pan. In a mixing bowl, cream together the **butter** and the **sugar**. Mash the **bananas** with a fork and add to the batter, along with the **eggs** and **vanilla**. Mix well.

Separately, whisk together all the **dry ingredients**, and add to the mix. Add the filling, mix well, and pour the batter into the bread pan.

Bake for 55-60 minutes, or until a toothpick comes out clean. Let rest in the pan for 10-20 minutes before transferring to a cooling rack.

[1] E.g., chocolate chips, nuts, raisins, oats, etc., or any combination of these.

Engadine Walnut Tart

Ingredients

Dough

- 325 g flour
- 100 g sugar
- 1 tsp baking powder
- 1 pinch salt
- 1 egg
- 2 tbsp cold water
- 175 g butter

Filling

- 200 g sugar
- 0.5 dl hot water
- 2.5 dl heavy cream
- 300 g walnuts
- 50 g honey

Mix the **flour** and **butter** using a mixer. Then combine the flour-butter mixture with the **sugar**, **baking powder**, and **salt** in a bowl. Add the **egg** and the **water**, and mix with a fork. Wrap in plastic wrap and refrigerate for about 30 minutes.

For the filling, caramelize the **sugar** slowly, pour in the **water**, and bring to a boil. Add the **cream** and simmer until the caramel has dissolved. Stir in the **walnuts** and **honey**. Continue stirring for a few minutes until the mixture thickens. Then let it cool.

Preheat the oven to 200°C conventional heat (top and bottom). Divide the dough into three parts. Roll out one third into a disc about 24 cm in ⌀ and refrigerate. Roll out the remaining dough on a lightly floured surface into a disc about 32 cm in ⌀ and place it in the buttered pan. Spread the filling evenly over the dough. Fold the edges of the dough inward and cover the tart with the smaller dough disc. Press the edges firmly with a fork and prick the top. Bake on the middle rack for about 30 minutes. Allow to cool completely (this is quite important).

The *Engadiner* (or *Bündner*) *Nusstorte* ('nut pie') is traditional of the alpine region of *Engiadina*, in the Kanton of Graubünden, Switzerland. This is my favorite pie ever.

Crêpes

Sweet or savory. Makes 15 crêpes of 20 cm (8 in) ⌀.

Ingredients

- 3 medium eggs
- 250 g (2 cups) flour
- 500 ml (2 cups) milk
- Butter, for greasing the pan
- 2 pinches of salt
- Sugar (optional)

Crack the **eggs** into a bowl, beat them with a fork, then add the **milk**, the **salt**, and, if desired, the **sugar**. Whisk in the **flour** until the batter is smooth and free of lumps. Heat a non-stick skillet over medium heat and pour in enough batter to make a crêpe of the desired size.[1] Flip the crêpe as soon as it releases easily from the pan.

[1] If available, use a crêpe spreader to spread the batter evenly over the bottom of the pan. Otherwise, simply tilt the pan or use a spatula to distribute the batter.

The Perfect Cheesecake

This recipe is reproduced almost verbatim from the version by Jerry P. Fairley's cookbook, in turn modified from the original found at www.simplyrecipes.com.

Ingredients

Crust

- 2 cups (200 g) graham cracker crumbs
- 2 tbsp (25 g) granulated sugar
- Pinch of salt
- 5 tbsp (70 g) unsalted butter

Filling

- 2 lbs (900 g) cream cheese **at room T°**
- 1⅓ cups (265 g) granulated sugar
- Pinch of salt
- 2 tsp vanilla extract
- 4 large eggs[1]
- ⅔ cup (160 g) sour cream
- ⅔ cup (160 g) heavy whipping cream

Toppings (optional)

- 2 cups (460 g) sour cream
- ⅓ cup (40 g) powdered sugar
- 1 tsp vanilla extract
- 12 oz (340 g) fresh raspberries, blackberries, or strawberries, finely diced
- ½ cup (100 g) granulated sugar
- ½ cup (120 g) water

Special equipment

- a 9-in (23 cm) diameter, 2¾ inch (7 cm) high springform pan
- Heavy-duty **18-in (45 cm) wide** aluminum foil (do not try to use regular-width aluminum foil)
- Parchment paper
- A large, high-sided roasting pan (large enough to contain the springform pan)

Crust:
Unroll a sheet of **parchment paper** the size of the **springform pan**. Using the bottom of the springform pan as a pattern, draw a circle on the parchment paper and carefully cut it out. It should just fit in the bottom of the pan. Set the parchment circle aside for now.

Spread out a kitchen towel on the counter and set the springform pan, upside-down, on the towel.[2] Carefully and gently tear-off a square of the wide **aluminum foil** that will completely cover the entire bottom and sides of the springform pan. Place the foil over the bottom of the pan and gently fold the foil down over the sides, then turn the pan over and crimp the foil all around the lip. Do all of this very carefully, on top of the towel, so you don't get even a

[1] US standard, ∼57 g each
[2] To avoid tearing or puncturing the delicate aluminum foil

little pinhole in the foil—if you do, start over with a new piece of aluminum foil. Once you get the first layer of aluminum foil on the springform pan, turn the pan upside-down again and put another piece of aluminum foil over the bottom and sides of the pan in exactly the same way as the first piece. This second layer of foil is an insurance policy in case the first layer has a tiny pinhole that you missed.

Put the **butter** in a microwave-proof bowl and heat it for 30 seconds. Wait for a couple of minutes, then swirl the bowl around and heat it again for 30 s. Let the bowl sit until any solid butter that is left melts completely. Place a baking rack in the bottom third of the oven and preheat to 350°F (177°C). Roughly break-up the **graham crackers** and pulse them in a food processor until they are finely-ground. Put the crumbs in a small or medium mixing bowl. Stir in the **sugar** and pinch of **salt**, then pour in the melted butter and mix well with your hands.

Keeping the pan on the kitchen towel (to minimize the chance of pinholes in the foil), put the circle of parchment paper into the bottom, inside the foil-wrapped springform pan, and dump in all the graham cracker crust mixture. Press the crumbs into the bottom of the pan,[3] leaving just a slightly thicker crust along the outside edge of the pan. Be very careful not to tear the aluminum foil while you do this (or while doing anything else).[4] Carefully (so you don't make a hole in the aluminum foil) place the springform pan on the rack in the oven and bake for 10 minutes. Remove the pan and place it on the kitchen towel. Reduce the oven temperature to 325°F (325°C).

Filling:
You can do all the following steps with a handheld electric mixer; however, if you have one, it is (a lot) easier to use a stand-mixer, and the finished product is actually better. Although it's hard work to mix the ingredients enough with a hand-mixer, with persisence, you can do it. The moral of the story is: if you want a good cheesecake, don't short the mixing times below, just because you are using a hand-mixer!

Put 2 quarts of water on to boil while you are preparing the filling, and keep them hot. You will need them after you make the filling, when you bake the cheesecake.

Cut the **cream cheese** up into chunks and place it all in a large mixing bowl. Mix the cream cheese[5] on medium speed for at least 4 minutes, or until it

[3] I usually use the bottom of a measuring cup first, then my fingers (or a spoon) to finish the job.

[4] If it seems as though I'm making a really big deal out of getting a hole in the aluminium foil, that's because I am. Even the tiniest hole will let water in the pan and spoil the crust. Making a good filling is tedious, but easy. The hardest part of making a good cheesecake is keeping the crust from being soggy. Trust me on this—it took me years to work out the crust part.

[5] If you have a stand-mixer, use the paddle attachment.

is light and fluffy. Add the **sugar**, then beat the mixture for another 4 minutes. Add the **salt** and beat for 2 minutes, then add the **vanilla** and beat for another 2 minutes. Add the **eggs**, one at a time, beating the batter for 1 minute after adding each egg. Add the **sour cream**, beating for 4 minutes, then add the **heavy cream**, beating for another 4 minutes. After each addition (sugar, salt, vanilla, eggs, sour cream, heavy cream), use a spatula to scrape the bottom and sides of the mixing bowl, to make sure all the little chunks of cream cheese get whipped and all the ingredients are completely incorporated.

Baking the cheesecake:
Carefully set the foil-wrapped springform pan in the large, high-sided roasting pan. Pour the cream cheese filling into the springform pan, on top of the graham cracker crust, and gently smooth the top with a rubber spatula if needed. Place the roasting pan (with the springform pan inside) on the lower rack (i.e., in the bottom third) of the oven. Pour the hot water (heated up in the previous step) into the roasting pan until it comes about halfway up the sides of the springform pan. The water should be 1¼ to 1½ inches (3 to 4 cm) deep.

Bake the cheesecake in the oven at 325°F (165°C) for at least 1½ hours. After 1½ hours, check to see if the cake is done by putting a bamboo skewer or a knife into the middle of the cake; if it comes out clean, the cake is done, but if there is goop (filling) on the knife, it needs more time. The top should be lightly browned; if it starts to look too brown, but the cheesecake still isn't completely done, use a piece of aluminum foil to loosely cover the top. The exact baking time is probably highly dependent on the oven. The original recipe says 1½ hours, but I have found it takes closer to 2½ hours in our oven, and I sometimes resort to turning up the temperature to 350°F (175°C). Make sure to top-up the water in the roasting pan if it gets too low, but I rarely find I need to add more water.

Once the cheesecake is set, turn off the oven and open the door about an inch, leaving the cheesecake inside. Let the cake cool for at least another hour, or longer if you like. I usually leave it until it is almost completely at room temperature. This helps keep the top of the cheesecake from developing cracks.

Once the cheesecake is cooled, take it out of the oven and cover it with foil, without letting the foil touch the top of the cheesecake. Put it in the refrigerator and chill overnight, or for a minimum of 4 hours.

Preparing the toppings:
While the cheesecake is baking, place the **sour cream** in a medium sized bowl and stir in the powdered sugar and vanilla. Mix until smooth, then cover and chill until you are ready to serve the cake.

Put the **raspberries** (or **blackberries**, or **strawberries**, or whatever you are using), **sugar**, and **water** into a small saucepan. Simmer the mixture, occasionally using a potato masher to crush-up the fruit. After about 5–10 minutes

the syrup will begin to get a little thicker. Once it starts to thicken, remove it from the heat and let it cool. Be careful not to overdo it, because the sauce will thicken more as it cools.

Serving the Cheesecake:
Take the cheesecake out of the refrigerator and remove the aluminum foil. Getting the springform pan off the cake without messing it up can be a little tricky. Try running a blunt knife around the inside of the pan, between the pan and the cake, before opening the latch on the pan. You can also try warming the sides of the pan (the original recipe suggests using a hair-dryer, but I've never had much success with that—I just use a knife). It might help to let the pan sit outside the refrigerator for 10–15 minutes before trying to unmold it, so the sides of the pan can warm up a little.

Anyway, once you unmold the springform pan from the cake, spread the top of the cheesecake with about half the sour cream topping. I suggest using a hot knife to cut the cake. I keep a kitchen towel (or paper towels) and a tall drinking glass full of hot water next to the cake; in between cutting each slice, I stick the knife in the water for a minute, then dry it off with the towel. This makes a mess of the towel, but you can always wash that later. Drizzle a little of the raspberry syrup on each slice and serve.

Note that the recipe for the sour cream topping makes more than you really need. I serve it on the side for people who want extra, but you can also serve the cheesecake without any sour cream dressing (or raspberry sauce, for that matter). The toppings are optional, and you can decide if you want to make (and use) them or not, depending on your tastes.

Making a cheesecake is a lot of work, although it does get easier after you've done it a few times. As I mentioned above, using a stand-mixer is a big help. Most of all, however, I have found the best cheesecakes are made with love! Love of baking, certainly, and also love for the person for whom you are making it. I don't know if you've ever noticed this, but I never make a cheesecake for myself—it's always easier to make it for someone that is dear to you.

Madeleines

Buttery and citrusy French muffins, my favorite breakfast along with croissants. Makes 24 madeleines.

Ingredients

- 1½ cups (175 g) flour
- ¾ cup (175 g) butter
- 3 eggs
- ¾ cup (150 g) granulated sugar
- ½ tsp baking powder
- 2 pinches of salt
- Zest of 1 orange
- Zest of 1 lemon
- 2 tsp (10 g) honey
- 1 tsp vanilla extract

Melt the **butter** in the microwave and let it cool until lukewarm. In a bowl, thoroughly mix **the sugar** and the **zests**. Add the melted **butter**, mix, then add the **eggs** and **vanilla**. Mix well[1] until obtaining a smooth and homogeneous batter.

Let the batter rest in the refrigerator for at least 1 hour.

Preheat the oven to 355°F (180°C), butter one or more madeleine molds, and divide the batter among 24 cavities.

Bake for 13 minutes. The madeleines are ready when they are golden brown and have formed their characteristic hump.

[1] Do not beat the mixture, otherwise the madeleines will become too airy and light.

Meringues

Yields about 20 meringues.

Ingredients

- 4 egg whites
- 300 g (1.5 cups) granulated sugar

Preheat the oven to 120°C (250°F), and prepare the **egg whites** at room temperature. Start by beating the whites at medium-low speed. When they begin to foam, if available, add a few drops of acid (lemon juice or white vinegar[1]).

As soon as the beaters start leaving trails in the foam, increase the speed to medium-high and sprinkle in ⅓ of the **sugar**.

Wait 1 to 2 minutes for the sugar to fully incorporate, then add the second third.

Add the final third when the meringue turns bright white and starts building volume.

Whip the meringue at maximum speed until it holds a firm stiff peak.

Shape[2] the meringues onto a baking sheet lined with parchment paper, then bake for 20 minutes at 120°C (250°F), followed by 1 hr at 100°C (210°F).

[1] Acid aids in retaining air bubbles, thus making it easier to achieve a firm whip. For geologists, 10% HCl is not a recommended alternative.

[2] Piping is not necessary; simply dollop small shapes using a spoon.

Pancakes

Makes 8 pancakes.

Ingredients

- 1½ cups (187 g) all-purpose flour
- 3½ tsp (14 g) baking powder
- 1 tsp (6 g) salt
- 1 tbsp (12 g) sugar
- 1½ cups (355 ml) milk
- 1 egg
- 3 tbsp (40 g) melted butter

Pour **all the powders** in a bowl and mix well. Make a hole in the middle and pour in **all the moist ingredients**. Make sure the eggs are well incorporated with the milk and butter before mixing to form a smooth batter. Preheat a non-stick skillet on medium-low heat. Grease the skillet before pouring ∼¼ cup of batter for each pancake.[1] As the pancake cooks, bubbles will form all over its raw surface. Flip the pancake once its bottom reaches the desired level of browning.[2]

Serve warm with butter and syrup, or with your preferred toppings.

[1] As opposed to Crêpes, pancakes should be thick, and must not be spread on the pan after the batter is poured.

[2] This can be checked by gently lifting the side of the pancake with a spatula.

Cooked Wine Tart

Made with Swiss "Vin Cuit" (literally "cooked wine"). A.k.a. "Tarte au Raisinée."

Ingredients

- 250 g sweet pastry (see recipe on page 30)
- 3 eggs
- 1 egg yolk
- 1.4 dl double cream[1]
- 1 dl Vaud-style *cooked wine*

Prepare the **sweet pastry** and leave it to rest. Roll out the pastry to a thickness of ½ cm and line a buttered and floured 20 cm diameter tart tin. Blind bake the pastry,[2] for approximately 25 minutes, in an oven at 250°C. Allow to cool without removing it from the tin.

Prepare the custard filling by whisking together the **remaining ingredients**.[3] Fill the pastry shell, place it in the preheated oven at 180°C, and finish filling it to the brim once the tart is in the oven, using a spoon.

Leave the oven door slightly ajar until the custard has set, approximately half an hour, and check the degree of doneness by gently shaking the tin. Remove from the tin while still lukewarm and place on a wire rack.

[1] A rich Swiss cream with about 45% fat.

[2] To prevent the pastry base from puffing up during blind baking, cover it with a disc of aluminium foil or baking paper and fill with chickpeas to keep it in place.

[3] Depending on the degree of reduction of the cooked wine, the quantity may need to be increased up to 1.2 dl.